

ODTE nearest-OTM package: per-rule return summary, entry 11:30 ET, one-bar hold, models compared on the same 866 days

	n	mean	std	min	max	skew	ex. kurt	t	Sharpe _{ann}	Sharpe _{ann} ^x
<i>Short volatility (always short)</i>										
all models (no forecast)	865	0.016	0.114	-1.06	0.21	-3.37	19.30	4.05	2.19	-2.13
<i>sign(s) (± 1 on the sign of s)</i>										
baseline (HAR + calendar OLS)	865	0.003	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.04	16.63	0.66	0.36	-4.04
block-diagonal ridge	865	0.001	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.03	16.73	0.22	0.12	-4.27
block-diagonal ridge, without the FOMC columns	865	-0.002	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.11	16.95	-0.50	-0.27	-4.66
LightGBM [†]	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.00	16.82	-0.09	-0.05	-4.44
XGBoost [†]	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.04	16.82	-0.10	-0.05	-4.44
lasso (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.15	16.76	0.12	0.06	-4.33
lasso ($\alpha = 10^{-4}$)	865	-0.000	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.05	16.80	-0.05	-0.03	-4.42
elastic net (causally tuned) [†]	865	0.001	0.116	-0.65	1.06	2.09	16.71	0.31	0.17	-4.23

One trade a day: enter the nearest-OTM package at 11:30 ET and exit thirty minutes later at the next stamp, in the same two strikes. 865 expiration days, 2020-01-03 to 2024-04-30 (the deck's frame). Fills are at the quoted midpoint everywhere except the last column, which is the same rule filled at the crossed spread: entry at the touch (the ask when long, the bid when short) and exit at the touch of the next stamp; the 15:30 leg cash-settles and pays no exit spread, and a re-pick that lands on the same two strikes with the same sign is a hold, not a round trip, so it is not charged. One expiration day = one return; mid fill. Every t here is the plain $t = \sqrt{n} \cdot \text{mean}/\text{std}$, with no autocorrelation correction.

“ex. kurt” is the bias-corrected sample excess kurtosis (Gaussian = 0). The short-volatility rule takes no forecast, so it is one row for all models. Sharpe_{ann} = (mean/std) $\times \sqrt{252}$; every other column is daily. The one column this table adds to the deck's is Sharpe_{ann}^x, the same rule's annualized Sharpe at the *crossed spread* instead of the midpoint; every other column is the deck's.

Forecasts: baseline (HAR + calendar OLS); block-diagonal ridge (HAR block and exogenous block, separate penalties) on the design carrying the FOMC calendar block, and the same ridge on the earlier design without those columns, as a diagnostic row; LightGBM and XGBoost on the all-features design; lasso on the same design, causally tuned vs. fixed $\alpha = 10^{-4}$; elastic net (causally tuned). [†] marks a column still fitted on the earlier design panel; a run of those four on the panel of record is pending. The signal is $s_t = \widehat{RV}_t - IV_{\text{hr}}^2 h_t w_t$: the forecast against the implied variance of the same window. On the bars whose vendor implied volatility is a censored solver node the deck's treatment is used here too — the volatility that reproduces the package midpoint, recovered by bisection over the remaining h_t hours — so every bar carries a signal and no bar sits flat.